



Table Top or Mini Pod

camera less steady. But usually photographers make use of the fully extended tripod to be able to capture pictures other than from the eye level most of the times, since this makes for an ordinary looking perspective. For photographers who take a lot of macro photos of subjects on the ground or those who like to use extreme vantage points in their pictures, the minimum height of the tripod is also a crucial consideration. Finally, there is the contracted tripod height, which is primarily for the photographers who need to fit their tripod in a backpack or suitcase, and depends mostly on the number of leg sections provided in the tripod.

Apart from regular tripods there are today a number of modifications in the original designs which allow for variations like tabletops, mini tripods or even monopods. A tabletop or mini tripod is a smaller, sized down version of a regular tripod, and used usually with compact cameras, again for increased portability.

This portability often comes at the expense of versatility, as tabletops can only really change the camera's left/right or up/down orientation and it is not possible to shift the camera to a higher or lower height. This can also be an advantage as it allows for taking interesting pictures from a different perspective rather than from eye level. But it can't be used in all terrains and locations as finding the best surface to place it is more important than when working with tripods.

Monopods

Monopods, the name being self-explanatory, in particular, are a popular option amongst enthusiasts who are not necessarily going to be shooting at extra slow speeds and require light and faster setting up options for photography on the move, and are most commonly used to hold up heavy cameras and lenses such as large telephoto lenses for sports or wildlife photography.

The lighter weight and size that monopods offer are probably their best features allowing for increased portability, and since only one leg has to